

Marking, Feedback & Assessment Policy

A Two-Way Dialogue Model: Meaningful, Manageable, and Motivating

Executive Summary: The History Department prioritizes high-impact feedback that accelerates student historical thinking while strictly maintaining teacher workload sustainability. In full compliance with DfE Teacher Workload Review recommendations and EEF research, performative 'tick-and-flick' marking is eliminated.

Our department operates a dual physical-digital architecture: bespoke printed **A4 Pupil Workbooks** provide a permanent, handwriting-focused record of extended analytical writing, while the digital **History Hub Web App** automates low-stakes retrieval practice. Central to our practice is **Two-Way Pupil Voice**: feedback is treated as a continuous dialogue where pupils actively evaluate their own progress, identify misconceptions, and respond immediately through dedicated reflection time.

CURRICULUM SCOPE
KS3 History & Pearson
Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

DEPARTMENT LEAD
Department Lead

POLICY STATUS
Approved for 2026–2027
Academic Year

The History Department adheres to the triad of **Meaningful, Manageable, and Motivating** feedback. Extensive research from the Education Endowment Foundation (EEF) demonstrates that retrospective written grading has negligible correlation with pupil attainment. Instead, teacher time is strategically redirected into in-lesson diagnostic questioning, high-quality modelling, and structured student response.

Physical-Digital Unified Architecture

We have eliminated loose sheets and disorganized exercise books by issuing bespoke, bound **A4 Pupil Workbooks** across KS3 and **GCSE Mastery Booklets** across KS4. The physical workbook guarantees a permanent, high-status record of extended historical essays, source evaluations, and disciplinary literacy. This is paired with the **History Hub App**, handling automated spaced retrieval practice without generating teacher marking workload.

Centring Two-Way Pupil Voice

Feedback is fundamentally a **dialogue, not a monologue**. During lessons, live verbal coaching obliges students to articulate historical explanations and defend causal arguments. At the end of every unit, pupils complete a structured self-evaluation in their workbooks, permanently documenting their reflections to inform adaptive departmental planning.

Visual Evidence: End-of-Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice Architecture

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Medieval England (1066–1485)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: 1 (Low) 2 3 4 5 (Excellent)

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)

Figure 2: End of Unit Reflection & Two-Way Pupil Voice (Page 24, Medieval England Workbook). Mandatory summative reflection permanently bound into the pupil workbook, capturing self-assessed effort (1–5 scale), pupil-identified strengths (WWW), misconceptions (EBI), forward targets, and dedicated teacher coaching.

WWW & EBI Diagnostic Loop: Students articulate which historical enquiries were easiest to master and specifically flag topics requiring reteaching (e.g. feudal land tenure vs Church courts).

Effort Self-Scoring & Accountability: By scoring personal effort from 1 (Low) to 5 (Excellent), students take direct ownership of their academic habits prior to receiving summative teacher feedback.

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Level	Emerging (1-2)	Emerging+ (3)	Expected (4-5)	Expected+ (6-7) / Greater Depth (8-9)
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments	
L1: Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?				
L2: Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?				
L3: Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?				
L4: Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?				
L5: Lesson 5: Doom Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?				
L6: Lesson 6: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?				
L7: Lesson 7: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?				
L8: Lesson 8: The Wars of the Roses (1455-1485) - How did the medieval era end in blood?				
L9: Lesson 9: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?				
Final Unit Grade:				

Figure 1: Inside Front Cover Progress & Assessment Tracker (Year 7 Workbook). Systematic front-cover audit trail tracking chronological enquiries, effort (1–5), pathway attainment, and live teacher commentary.

KS3 Assessment Frequency: Two formal feedback homeworks per half term (1 digital 'Read Out Loud' on Teams + 1 teacher-marked written piece) + 1 formal end-of-unit summative assessment recorded on the inside cover.

Inside Front Cover Tracking Grid

Every Key Stage 3 workbook opens with a standardized **Progress & Assessment Tracker**, creating an open audit trail for pupils, parents, and school leadership:

- **Chronological Enquiries:** Full mapping of enquiry lessons.
- **Effort Score (1–5):** Evaluates in-lesson diligence and workbook pride.
- **Pathway Level:** Logs emerging, expected, or greater depth standard.
- **Formative Dialogue:** Space for live teacher stamps or student self-notes.

Effort Scoring Rubric (1–5 Scale)

Score	Pupil Learning Behaviors
5 • Exemplary	Proactive historical curiosity; completes extension tasks; exemplary presentation.
4 • Good	Consistent engagement; thoughtful contributions; all core tasks completed.
3 • Satisfactory	Meets baseline expectations; requires occasional teacher prompting.
2 • Inconsistent	Incomplete written tasks; frequent off-task reminders; lacks pride.
1 • Concern	Persistent passivity or refusal; triggers departmental parental contact.

Dynamic Vocabulary Pedagogy

To secure disciplinary literacy, workbooks dynamically rotate across 3 cognitive styles:

- 1. Contextual Cloze:** High-yield retrieval summaries targeting key terms.
- 2. Vocabulary Mapping:** Synthesizing two terms into a causal sentence.
- 3. Dual-Term Analytical Distinction:** Explaining critical differences between confusable concepts.

Domino Flowchart Chronology

Timeline starters are formatted as *Domino Flowcharts* with scrambled event nodes. Pupils draw causal arrows and justify historical sequence over rote memorization.

3. Key Stage 4 (GCSE 9–1) Architecture & Stepped Mastery

KEY STAGE 4 • EDEXCEL

GCSE History requires pupils to master complex, divergent exam tariffs ranging from 2-mark recall features to 16+4-mark thematic judgement essays. The department employs systematic PEE/PEEL Structure Strips and Causal Connective Banks within our bespoke **GCSE Section B Mastery Booklets**:

SECTION B PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER (36+4 MARKS TOTAL)			Marked by Teacher or Peer Verified
Assessment Component & Stem Focus	Format Style	Max Marks	Pupil Score
Complete 4-Era Knowledge Vault (All 280 Recall Questions)	Checklist	/280	_____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q3 Similarity / Difference (Medieval vs Renaissance)	Stepped Ladder	/4	_____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q4 Explain Why (Surgical Progress c1700–c1900)	Stepped Ladder	/12	_____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q5/Q6 Statement Essay (Germ Theory vs Public Health)	Stepped Ladder	/16+4	_____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q3 Similarity / Difference (Great Plague vs Black Death)	Dual Track	/4	_____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q4 Explain Why (Penicillin Mass Production c1938–45)	Dual Track	/12	_____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q5/Q6 Statement Essay (Four Humours c1250–c1700)	Dual Track	/16+4	_____
Round 3 (Simulation): Section B Full Exam Hall Simulation (Q3, Q4, Q5/6)	Exam Pitch (55m)	/36+4	_____
TOTAL COMBINED EXAM PRACTICE MARKS:		/104	_____ / 104
Teacher / Peer Marker: _____		Date: _____	Overall Grade: [9 8 7 6 5 4]

Figure 3: Section B Progress & Assessment Tracker (Page 1, Edexcel Medicine Mastery Booklet). Visual tracking table mapping student journey through the 280-question recall vault, Round 1 (Stepped Enquiries), Round 2 (Dual-Track Enquiries), and Round 3 (55-minute Full Exam Pitch Simulation).

Systematic 3-Round Progression

- Round 1 (Stepped Enquiries):** PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, and model answers across Q3 (4m), Q4 (12m), and Q5/Q6 (16+4m).
- Round 2 (Dual-Track Enquiries):** Differentiated choice between guided PEE/PEEL Structure Strips (Track A) or independent exam conditions (Track B) targeting Grades 7–9.
- Round 3 (Exam Simulation):** Timed 55-minute assessment trial replicating exact Edexcel mark scheme standards.

Specification-Specific PEE/PEEL Structure Strips

- Paper 1 Western Front (Section A):** Feature questions exist *strictly* as two separate 2-mark questions: Q1(a) [2m] and Q1(b) [2m].
- Paper 2 Early Elizabethan England:** Feature questions strictly structured as two distinct 2-mark questions: Q1(a) [2m] and Q1(b) [2m].
- Paper 2 Middle East:** Consequence question format strictly reflects the updated single 4-mark requirement ('Explain one consequence of...').

Source Provenance Prompts & Structure Strips ('How Useful' Questions)

Source provenance is the single most common stumbling block for GCSE candidates. In all source-utility assessments, the department embeds explicit **Provenance Clue Boxes** prompting students to dissect:

1. Author & Expert Status: Who created the source, what was their direct medical/military role, and what access did they have to firsthand evidence?

2. Audience & Confidentiality: Was this written for a private diary, official military command (RAMC), or public wartime home-front propaganda?

3. Motive & Limitations: Why was it created at that specific date, what does it deliberately omit, and how does it corroborate contextual knowledge?

The Four Golden Rules for GCSE Historical Writing: (1) Substantive evidence over vague generalizations; (2) Sustained analytical focus on the explicit question concept (causation, similarity, utility); (3) Purpose-led provenance evaluation over superficial bias labels; (4) Criteria-driven comparative judgement in 16-mark essays.

4. Departmental Intelligence, Mock Packs & Digital Auto-Marking

DATA & TECHNOLOGY

To prevent teacher marking fatigue while maximizing student exam readiness, the department utilizes a bespoke **Exam Trend Matrix & Specification Gap Radar**. This replaces blind past paper marking with data-driven surgical rehearsals.

QUESTION FOCUS	2018	2019	2020	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Section A: Western Front Historic Environment Enquiry 16m (Q1 Features: 4m • Q2a Utility: 8m • Q2b Follow-Up: 4m)	SECTION A [16m] Treatment of Battle Injuries Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] Stretcher Bearers Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] Gas Attacks Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] Trench Foot Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] New Techniques to Deal with Injuries Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] Medical Staff in Casualty Clearing Stations Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] Difficulties in Caring for the Wounded Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] Transporting Wounded Along Evacuation Chain Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m
Q3: Similarity / Difference 4m (Thematic c1250-present)	Q3 [4m] Medieval vs Industrial Hospital Care	Q3 [4m] Ideas About Causes of Illness: 18th/19th Century vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Medieval Physician vs NHS Doctor	Q3 [4m] Preventing Infectious Diseases: Renaissance vs Industrial	Q3 [4m] Prevention of Illness: Medieval vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Treatment of Infectious Diseases: Medieval vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Epidemics: Great Plague (1665) vs Cholera (1854)	Q3 [4m] Preventing Infectious Diseases: Renaissance vs Modern
Q4: Causation Explanation 12m (Thematic c1250-present)	Q4 [12m] Prevention of Illness c1700-present	Q4 [12m] Renaissance Medical Knowledge c1500-c1700	Q4 [12m] Science & Technology in Modern Medicine c1900-present	Q4 [12m] Attitudes Towards Surgery c1800-present	Q4 [12m] Access to Medical Care & Treatment in Modern Period	Q4 [12m] Why Little Change in Medieval Medicine c1250-c1500	Q4 [12m] Impact of Pasteur's Germ Theory c1861-present	Q4 [12m] Hospital Care & Treatment Improvements c1700-c1900
Q5: Judgement Essay (Choice A) 16m + 4m SPaG (Extended)	Q5 [16m] Understanding Cause of Disease c1250-c1700	Q5 [16m] Galen & Medieval Medical Care c1250-c1500	Q5 [16m] Florence Nightingale & Hospital Care c1700-c1900	Q5 [16m] Medieval Care & Treatment: Role of Physician c1250-c1500	Q5 [16m] Thomas Sydenham as Key Turning Point c1500-c1700	Q5 [16m] Progress in Medical Knowledge in Renaissance c1500-c1700	Q5 [16m] Four Humours & Medicine c1250-c1700	Q5 [16m] Medieval Ideas on Cause of Illness: Religion vs Nature c1250-c1500
Q6: Judgement Essay (Choice B) 16m + 4m SPaG (Extended)	Q6 [16m] Advances in Surgery: 18th/19th Century vs 20th Century	Q6 [16m] Role of Government in Medicine c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Infectious Diseases c1500-c1900	Q6 [16m] Pasteur & Causes of Illness c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Attitudes Towards Medicine c1700-c1900	Q6 [16m] Role of Individuals in Prevention c1700-present	Q6 [16m] Role of Government in Hospital Care c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Science & Technology as Main Reason for Modern Progress c1900-present

Figure 4: Pearson Edexcel GCSE Past Exam Question Matrix (8-Series Longitudinal Analysis, 2018–2026). Departmental database mapping all 8 exam series across Medicine, Elizabethan, Middle East, Germany, and USA. Flags overdue question tariffs and unexamined syllabus points for high-leverage classroom rehearsals.

Data-Driven Target Rehearsals

Rather than having teachers mark entire 52-mark past papers every fortnight, the **Specification Gap Radar** identifies high-probability 'overdue' topics (e.g. Modern Public Health 16m essays or Medieval Surgery 12m causation). The department conducts 15-minute high-yield timed trials on these exact question stems, followed immediately by whole-class live modelling.

One-Click Classroom Mock Packs

The web application enables instant generation of authentic **4-Page Section B Mock Exam Dossiers**. These compile official Edexcel typography, source boxes, and lined response pages with zero teacher administrative formatting time, enabling regular, low-friction exam hall trial runs.

Digital Automated Marking: 20-Question Knowledge Vaults

Every unit in the curriculum is supported by an automated 20-question **Mastery Vault** within the History Hub Web App. Pupils complete spaced retrieval quizzes on laptops or mobile devices, receiving instantaneous automated scoring, diagnostic explanations, and Leitner flashcard reinforcement. This delivers rigorous continuous recall practice with **zero teacher marking hours**, freeing faculty to focus entirely on qualitative essay feedback.

Live In-The-Moment Feedback

During independent writing phases, teachers actively circulate and review work in progress. Misconceptions in historical chronology, source inferences, or essay structure are addressed immediately, allowing students to refine their work in real time.

Whole-Class Feedback & Dedicated Reflection (DIRT)

Following major written assessments, teachers compile diagnostic findings onto a single **Whole-Class Feedback Sheet** rather than writing repetitive comments in individual books. Students complete dedicated **DIRT**, redrafting key paragraphs and addressing targeted misconceptions.

Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar (SPaG) Marking Code

Symbol	Meaning	Symbol	Meaning
Sp	Incorrect historical / general spelling	^	Word omitted
P	Punctuation error (full stop, comma)	?	Meaning unclear / illogical phrase
G	Grammatical issue / tense agreement	!	Historical factual inaccuracy
C	Capital letter required (proper noun)	✓	Valid historical evidence / sound point
//	New paragraph required (PEEL structure)	✓✓	Exceptional historical insight / sustained analysis

Assessment Pathways & GCSE Indicative Bands

Pathway Level	Descriptor	Assessment % Band	GCSE Indicative Grade
Greater Depth (GD)	Sophisticated analysis, nuanced historical synthesis, perceptive judgements.	80% – 100%	Grades 8 – 9
Expected+ (Exp+)	Secure explanations, well-selected evidence, clear causal reasoning.	60% – 79%	Grades 6 – 7
Expected (Exp)	Sound descriptive knowledge, structured paragraphs, basic historical analysis.	40% – 59%	Grades 4 – 5
Emerging+ (EM+)	Partial recall, simple assertions, emerging chronological awareness.	30% – 39%	Grade 3
Emerging (EM)	Fragmented knowledge, requires frequent PEE/PEEL Structure Strips to complete tasks.	10% – 29%	Grades 1 – 2

Quality Assurance & Moderation Schedule:

- Termly collaborative work scrutinies evaluating student reflection, redrafts, and progress over time.
- Formal GCSE mock standardization against official Pearson Edexcel anchor scripts and examiners' reports.
- Inside-cover tracking grids shared directly at Parents' Consultations to celebrate effort and attainment.